

ANSWER KEY

Powers to Arrest — BSIS Certification Course

Instructor & Company Copy
Retain securely — not for student distribution

55 Questions | Passing Score: 100% | BPC §7583.7

MACCESS INC.

PPO License #122729 | BSIS-Authorized Training Provider | June 27, 2026

QUICK REFERENCE — ALL ANSWERS

55 Questions

Q1	B	Q2	D	Q3	B	Q4	C	Q5	C
Q6	C	Q7	B	Q8	B	Q9	D	Q10	C
Q11	B	Q12	C	Q13	C	Q14	A	Q15	B
Q16	B	Q17	C	Q18	C	Q19	B	Q20	D
Q21	B	Q22	B	Q23	C	Q24	C	Q25	C
Q26	D	Q27	D	Q28	B	Q29	C	Q30	C

1

Module 1 — Legal Framework

BPC §7583.7

Which California law requires security guards to complete Power to Arrest training before receiving a guard card?

A. California Penal Code §837

✓ B. Business and Professions Code §7583.7

C. Title 16 California Code of Regulations §643

D. California Penal Code §847

B

2

Module 1 — Legal Framework

BPC §7583.7

What score must a student achieve on the BSIS Power to Arrest exam to receive a Certificate of Completion?

A. 70%

B. 80%

C. 90%

✓ D. 100%

D

3

Module 1 — Legal Framework

DCA PTA Manual July 2023

Which manual is required to be used for Power to Arrest and Appropriate Use of Force training?

A. California Security Officer Handbook 2022

✓ B. DCA Power to Arrest and Appropriate Use of Force Training Manual 2023

C. BSIS Regulatory Guide Title 16

D. California Penal Code Annotated

B

4

Module 1 — Legal Framework

BPC §7583.7

As a security guard in California, your arrest authority comes from the same law that applies to:

- A. A sworn police officer
- B. A licensed investigator
- ✓ C. A private citizen
- D. A government contractor

C

5

Module 1 — Legal Framework

SB 652 (Jan 1 2026)

Under SB 652 effective January 1, 2026, the full 8-hour PTA + AUF training must be delivered by:

- A. Any two BSIS-approved providers
- B. The applicant's employer only
- ✓ C. A single BSIS-approved course provider
- D. An online provider plus a separate in-person facility

C

6

Module 1 — Legal Framework

SB 652 | BPC §7583.6

How long before a guard card application must the 8-hour PTA/AUF training be completed?

- A. 30 days
- B. 3 months
- ✓ C. 6 months
- D. 1 year

C

7

Module 1 — Legal Framework

BPC §7583.7

MACCESS INC. is authorized to deliver this certification as a licensed:

- A. Peace officer agency
- C. Federal security contractor

- ✓ **B. Private Patrol Operator — PPO #122729**
- D. BSIS examination center

B

8

Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837

California Penal Code §837 lists how many conditions under which a private person may make a citizen's arrest?

- A. Two
- C. Four

- ✓ **B. Three**
- D. Five

B

9

Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837(1)

Under PC §837(1), a security guard may make a citizen's arrest when a public offense is:

- A. Reported by a witness
- C. Captured on CCTV footage only

- B. Suspected based on prior criminal history
- ✓ **D. Committed or attempted in the guard's direct presence**

D

10

Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837(2)

Under PC §837(2), a guard may arrest someone for a felony not committed in their presence if:

- A. A supervisor authorizes the arrest
- B. The guard has a hunch the person is guilty
- ✓ C. The guard knows the person committed the felony
- D. The property owner requests the arrest

C

11

Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837(3)

PC §837(3) requires that for a reasonable-cause felony arrest, a felony must:

- A. Be suspected but not confirmed
- ✓ B. Have actually been committed in fact
- C. Have been reported to police first
- D. Involve violence or weapons

B

12

Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837

A guard receives a report that someone stole from the store yesterday. The guard did not witness it. Can the guard make a citizen's arrest for this misdemeanor?

- A. Yes — any theft justifies arrest
- B. Yes — with supervisor approval
- ✓ C. No — misdemeanor arrest requires personal observation
- D. No — only police can arrest for theft

C

13

Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837(3)

Which PC §837 arrest condition carries the greatest risk of personal liability if used incorrectly?

- A. §837(1) — offense in presence
✓ C. §837(3) — reasonable cause for felony
B. §837(2) — felony committed by that person
D. All conditions carry equal risk

C

14

Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837

A security guard witnesses a person vandalizing a car in the parking lot. Which PC §837 condition applies?

- ✓ A. §837(1) — public offense in presence
C. §837(3) — reasonable cause
B. §837(2) — felony committed by the person
D. None — vandalism cannot justify arrest

A

15

Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837

"Reasonable cause" under PC §837 means:

- A. A gut feeling the person looks suspicious
C. A witness statement alone
✓ B. Objective facts supporting a belief the person committed a felony
D. Prior criminal history of the person

B

16

Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837 | PC §490.5

The Shopkeeper's Privilege under PC §490.5 allows detention for shoplifting when there is:

- A. Suspicion based on appearance
- C. A manager's verbal authorization

- ✓ B. Probable cause based on direct observation
- D. A description matching prior theft reports

B

17

Module 3 — Limitations & Prohibited Actions

PC §538d

A security guard who represents themselves as a police officer may face criminal charges under:

- A. PC §602
- ✓ C. PC §538d

- B. BPC §480
- D. PC §836

C

18

Module 3 — Limitations & Prohibited Actions

PC §837 | 4th Amendment

A security guard's search authority during a lawful detention is limited to:

- A. A full search of the person's clothing and bags
- ✓ C. A safety pat-down for weapons only

- B. An unlimited search on private property
- D. Any search authorized by the property owner

C

19

Module 3 — Limitations & Prohibited Actions

PC §236 | PC §847

Courts generally view a detention lasting more than ____ minutes without police notification as potentially false imprisonment.

A. 5–10 minutes

✓ B. 20–30 minutes

C. 45–60 minutes

D. 2 hours

B

20

Module 3 — Limitations & Prohibited Actions

PC §837

A security guard's arrest authority extends:

A. Anywhere in the city they are assigned

B. Throughout the entire county

C. Statewide under their BSIS license

✓ D. Only on the property they are hired to protect

D

21

Module 3 — Limitations & Prohibited Actions

PC §236

Detaining someone without a lawful basis under PC §837 constitutes:

A. Lawful preventive detention

✓ B. False imprisonment

C. Authorized security action

D. Investigative detention

B

22

Module 3 — Limitations & Prohibited Actions

PC §242

A security guard handcuffs someone without a lawful basis for arrest. This action could constitute:

- A. Lawful restraint under BPC §7583.7
C. Authorized preventive security action

- ✓ B. False imprisonment and assault under California law
D. A civil matter only with no criminal exposure

B

23

Module 3 — Limitations & Prohibited Actions

PC §837

A guard detains a person based solely on their race and a manager's vague concern. This detention is:

- A. Lawful under employer authority
✓ C. Unlawful — race alone is never reasonable suspicion

- B. Lawful if the manager signed a form
D. Lawful for 30 minutes pending investigation

C

24

Module 4 — Security vs. Law Enforcement

PC §830

California peace officer authority is derived from:

- A. Penal Code §837
✓ C. Penal Code §830 et seq.

- B. Business and Professions Code §7583.7
D. Title 16 CCR §643

C

25

Module 4 — Security vs. Law Enforcement

PC §837 | PC §830

Which power does a peace officer have that a security guard does NOT?

- A. The power to observe and report
- ✓ C. The power to conduct lawful searches based on probable cause developed through investigation
- B. The power to make a citizen's arrest
- D. The power to ask a person their name

C

26

Module 4 — Security vs. Law Enforcement

PC §847

After making a citizen's arrest, a security guard must deliver the person to a peace officer:

- A. Within 24 hours
- B. At the end of the guard's shift
- C. After completing an incident report
- ✓ D. Without unnecessary delay

D

27

Module 4 — Security vs. Law Enforcement

PC §847

When a police officer accepts custody from a security guard who made a citizen's arrest, who is legally the arresting party?

- A. The police officer
- B. Both equally
- C. The property owner who authorized the guard
- ✓ D. The security guard — the private person

D

28

Module 4 — Security vs. Law Enforcement

BPC §7582.1

California security guards are classified under the law as:

- A. Peace officers with limited jurisdiction
- C. Federal contractors

✓ **B. Private persons — no additional authority from their badge**

D. Agents of the property owner with police powers on private property

B

29

Module 5 — Liability

PC §236

False imprisonment under California Penal Code §236 is defined as:

A. Arresting someone for a misdemeanor

B. Detaining someone for more than one hour

✓ **C. The unlawful violation of the personal liberty of another**

D. Any physical contact with a detained person

C

30

Module 5 — Liability

PC §207

If a security guard unlawfully detains someone AND moves them to another location, the charge could escalate to:

A. Disorderly conduct

B. Assault

✓ **C. Kidnapping under PC §207**

D. Trespassing

C

31

Module 5 — Liability

BPC §480

A guard who makes an unlawful arrest could face BSIS consequences including:

A. A written warning only

✓ B. Guard card suspension or revocation under BPC §480

C. Mandatory additional training only

D. No regulatory consequences — only civil liability

B

32

Module 5 — Liability

Vicarious Liability

MACCESS INC. as the PPO may be held liable for a guard's wrongful arrest under the doctrine of:

A. Strict product liability

B. Qualified immunity

✓ C. Vicarious liability

D. Contributory negligence

C

33

Module 5 — Liability

PC §242

A guard uses excessive force during a detention. Which criminal charge most directly applies?

A. Trespassing

✓ B. Battery under PC §242

C. Vandalism

D. Disturbing the peace

B

34

Module 5 — Liability

BPC §7583.2

BSIS must be notified when a security guard is involved in certain incidents including use of force per:

A. PC §837

B. Title 16 CCR §600

✓ C. BPC §7583.2

D. PC §242

C

35

Module 6 — Trespass & Property Law

PC §602

Under California Penal Code §602, trespass is generally classified as a:

A. Felony

B. Infraction only

C. Civil violation only

✓ D. Misdemeanor

D

36

Module 6 — Trespass & Property Law

PC §602 | PC §837(1)

A person refuses to leave private property after a lawful order. Under PC §837(1), an arrest may be lawful because:

A. The property owner requested it

B. Guards always have authority to arrest trespassers

✓ C. The refusal constitutes a public offense in the guard's presence

D. BSIS license authorizes this action

C

37

Module 6 — Trespass & Property Law

Civil Rights Law

When removing someone from a public accommodation, a security guard must have a reason that is:

- A. The same authority as on private property
- B. Written and approved by the property manager
- ✓ C. Specific and legitimate — unrelated to any protected characteristic
- D. Approved by law enforcement in advance

C

38

Module 6 — Trespass & Property Law

PC §602

For trespass enforcement on open land, what is generally required before detaining a person?

- A. A written order from a judge
- B. A prior BSIS incident report
- C. Police authorization in writing
- ✓ D. Clear posting or fencing and a verbal warning first

D

39

Module 7 — Ethics, Communication & Documentation

Title 16 CCR §643(b)

Per Title 16 CCR §643(b), a Certificate of Completion must be issued for each course completed by:

- A. BSIS directly to the guard
- B. The applicant's attorney
- C. The property owner
- ✓ D. The training entity or company providing the training

D

40

Module 7 — Ethics, Communication & Documentation

BSIS PTA Manual §8

An incident report should ideally be completed:

- A. At the end of the guard's shift
- B. The following business day
- C. Only when requested by a supervisor
- ✓ **D. Within 1 hour of the incident**

D

41

Module 7 — Ethics, Communication & Documentation

BSIS Ethics Standards

A security guard who falsifies an incident report may face:

- A. A verbal warning only
- B. A civil fine only
- C. No consequences if the incident was minor
- ✓ **D. Termination and BSIS license revocation**

D

42

Module 7 — Ethics, Communication & Documentation

BSIS Ethics Standards

A security guard's enforcement decisions must be free from bias based on:

- A. The guard's professional intuition
- B. Employer policies regardless of law
- ✓ **C. Race, gender, appearance, or other protected characteristics**
- D. The property owner's personal preferences

C

43

Module 7 — Ethics, Communication & Documentation

BSIS PTA Manual §8

When a security guard announces a citizen's arrest, they should:

- A. Remain silent to avoid legal exposure
C. Only announce after police arrive

B. Wait for police to make any statement

✓ D. Clearly state the basis for the arrest in plain language

D

44

Module 7 — Ethics, Communication & Documentation

Title 16 CCR §643(b)

Training records must be maintained by the PPO and made available to BSIS for:

A. 6 months

B. 1 year

✓ C. Audit upon request — for the duration of employment

D. 5 years after termination

C

45

Module 8 — Emergency Response & Officer Safety

BSIS PTA Manual §9

When a security guard discovers a medical emergency, their FIRST action should be:

A. Notify their supervisor

B. Begin medical treatment immediately regardless of training

✓ C. Assess the scene for personal safety, then call 911

D. Secure the area and wait for police

C

46

Module 8 — Emergency Response & Officer Safety

DHS Run-Hide-Fight

In an active shooter situation, the recommended priority order of actions is:

A. Hide, Fight, Run

B. Fight, Hide, Run

C. Call 911, Hide, Fight

✓ D. Run, Hide, Fight

D

47

Module 8 — Emergency Response & Officer Safety

BSIS PTA Manual §10

Blood-borne pathogen precautions require a security guard to:

A. Refuse all physical contact with subjects

B. Request a hazmat team for all incidents

C. Document exposure only after the fact

✓ D. Wear gloves before any physical contact that may involve blood or bodily fluids

D

48

Module 8 — Emergency Response & Officer Safety

BSIS PTA Manual §10

When law enforcement arrives at a scene where a security guard has made a citizen's arrest, the guard should:

A. Continue managing the situation until formally relieved

B. Announce their BSIS authority first

✓ C. Keep hands visible and follow all officer commands

D. Present their guard card immediately and speak first

C

49

Module 8 — Emergency Response & Officer Safety

BSIS PTA Manual §10

Situational awareness means:

- A. Watching only the primary entry point
- C. Focusing on the most suspicious-looking individual

✓ **B. Knowing your exits and continuously monitoring your environment for threats**

- D. Staying stationary to observe from one position

B

50

Module 9 — Knowledge Check & Exam Prep

PC §847

A security guard makes a lawful citizen's arrest. How long may the guard hold the person before law enforcement must be contacted?

- A. Up to 4 hours
- C. Up to 24 hours if police are unavailable

- B. Until the end of the shift

✓ **D. Without unnecessary delay — no extended holding permitted**

D

51

Module 9 — Knowledge Check & Exam Prep

PC §837 | PC §836

Which BEST distinguishes a security guard's arrest authority from a police officer's?

- A. Guards can only arrest on weekdays
- C. Guards must have a supervisor present for all arrests

- B. Guards cannot use handcuffs under any circumstances

✓ **D. Guards cannot arrest based on probable cause developed through their own investigation**

D

52

Module 9 — Knowledge Check & Exam Prep

PC §837(1) | PC §602

A guard observes shoplifting in real time. The person drops the item and tries to leave. Best course of action?

A. Physically tackle the person to prevent escape

B. Follow the person into the parking lot and arrest there

C. Take no action — only managers can stop shoplifters

✓ D. Detain on property with reasonable force and immediately call

D

53

Module 9 — Knowledge Check & Exam Prep

PC §837 | BPC §7583.7

A security guard may NEVER make a citizen's arrest for a misdemeanor if:

A. The offense occurred on private property

B. The person is not a repeat offender

✓ C. The guard did not personally witness the offense

D. The offense occurred after business hours

C

54

Module 9 — Knowledge Check & Exam Prep

BPC §7583.7

MACCESS INC.'s California Private Patrol Operator license number is:

A. #112233

B. #100001

C. #133445

✓ D. #122729

D

55

Module 9 — Knowledge Check & Exam Prep

PC §847 | BSIS Training Standards

After a citizen's arrest, a guard who holds the subject for 2 hours without calling police may face:

- A. No consequences if the arrest was lawful
- ✓ **B. Praise for thorough documentation**
- C. False imprisonment charges and BSIS disciplinary action
- D. A supervisor review only

B

SCORING GUIDE & INSTRUCTOR INSTRUCTIONS

Passing Score

100% — all 55 questions must be answered correctly per BPC §7583.7

Scoring Method

1 point per correct answer. No partial credit. No penalty for wrong answers beyond the failed score.

Retake Policy

Students who fail must retake the full assessment. Recommend review of specific modules where errors occurred.

Certificate

Issue MACCESS INC. Certificate of Completion only to students achieving 100%. Sign and date each certificate.

Record Keeping

Retain a copy of each student's completed assessment and certificate per Title 16 CCR §643(b). Records subject to BSIS audit.

Answer Key Security

This document is for MACCESS INC. instructor and administrative use only. Do not share with students before, during, or after the assessment.

Module Weighting

Questions are distributed across 9 modules. Review incorrect answers by module to identify knowledge gaps.